

Make Hard Work Your Passion: Wrap-Up, Featuring Phillip Fulmer

Phillip Fulmer, Head Coach for the 1998 National Championship Football Team, University of Tennessee

Pat had many sayings, but one of my favorites was, “We simulate, prepare and train so that the task of winning does not seem daunting. It’s what we are supposed to do because we have worked hard all year. We expect to win because we practice it. I believe you get what you expect.”

In this module, we learned that hard work is applying yourself fully to achieving the things that are within your control. Winning is about daily improvement, and those who put in effort every single day train themselves to expect victory. Showing up to give your best every day isn’t easy, but it helps if you truly believe in what you’re doing.

As we covered earlier, hard work requires commitment and great rewards demand sacrifice. Be willing to push yourself and get out of your comfort zone. You want people who will encourage you and inspire you toward a goal, not hold you back.

Next, have a plan for your work. Planning helps you tackle multiple things in a systematic fashion and keeps you from getting overwhelmed. Make a prioritized list of tasks and continually focus on what is doable to keep yourself moving forward on that path.

Finally, put your commitment and preparation on display by following through with the execution of your vision for success. Hard work generates the confidence you need to secure victory. Even when it’s hard, put in the necessary work and remember that you’re working for your best interest by investing in your dreams.

Pat said, “The best work should have an alive quality. It should be performed with some feeling, even with passion. You may not think your intention is visible, but it is. The intent is obvious in your every action, more so than you would ever know.” What you focus on is what you create. If you envision a successful future for yourself, then make hard work your passion and form daily habits that will set you on the path to making that future a reality.